

UK Merchant Payment Setup & Compliance Guide

Requirements for Accepting Online & Local Payments in Liverpool, UK

Tailored for: Green Clean Group Business Owner | Prepared: September 2026

1. Executive Overview & 2 Payment Modes

This website is built exclusively for Green Clean Group providing eco-friendly home and oven cleaning services to customers across Liverpool and Merseyside (L1–L39, CH, WA postcodes). To maximize customer bookings while ensuring secure, modern financial operations, the booking engine has been streamlined to support exactly two payment modes:

MODE 1: Pay Locally upon Arrival (Cash or Mobile Card)

- Customer selects 'I will pay locally (cash or credit card)' at online checkout.
- Booking is confirmed immediately with zero online pre-payment friction.
- Technician collects payment on the day of service via physical cash or handheld card terminal.
- Recorded in your database as: Payment Method = 'local', Payment Status = 'pending'.

MODE 2: Pay Online with Credit Card via Stripe (Pre-paid)

- Customer selects 'I will pay now with credit card' at online checkout.
- Processed securely in GBP (£) using the official Stripe UK gateway.
- Fully compliant with UK Strong Customer Authentication (SCA / 3D Secure 2).
- Funds are transferred directly to your UK business bank account on an automated rolling schedule.

2. UK Banking Requirements for Accepting Payments

To receive online customer payments into your business, Stripe UK and UK banking laws require you to link a valid UK sterling bank account. You must provide the following two numbers:

UK Banking Detail	Format & Description	Acceptable Sources
6-Digit Sort Code	Format: XX-XX-XX (e.g. 20-45-45). Identifies your UK bank branch.	Bank card, statement, or banking app.
8-Digit Account No	Format: 8 numerical digits (e.g. 12345678). Your direct bank account.	UK bank statement / online banking.
Account Holder Name	Must strictly match your Sole Trader legal name or Ltd Company name.	Barclays, HSBC, NatWest, Lloyds, Santander, Starling, Monzo.

Important UK Payout Standard:

Stripe UK transfers all card payments via BACS Faster Payments directly to this UK bank account on a rolling 2-day or weekly schedule. There is no manual withdrawal required; it deposits automatically into your account.

3. UK Legal Entity & Identity Verification (KYC / AML)

Under UK Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) anti-money laundering regulations, every merchant accepting card payments in the UK must complete basic identity verification. Depending on how your business is registered in the UK, you need to provide:

IF SOLE TRADER (Self-Employed):

1. Full Legal Name & Date of Birth
(Must match official UK identity documents).
2. National Insurance (NI) Number
(e.g., QQ 12 34 56 A).
3. Unique Taxpayer Reference (UTR)
10-digit number issued by HMRC for UK tax.
4. Proof of Liverpool Address
UK Council tax bill, utility bill, or bank statement dated within the last 3 months.
5. Valid UK Photo ID
UK Passport or UK Photocard Driving Licence.

IF LIMITED COMPANY (Ltd):

1. Companies House Registration Number (CRN)
8-digit company number (e.g., 12345678).
2. Company Legal Name & Registered Office
As officially recorded at Companies House.
3. VAT Number (If Registered)
If turnover exceeds £90,000 threshold, or state 'Not VAT Registered'.
4. Director & Significant Owner Details

Full name, address, DOB, and photo ID for

4. Stripe Account Setup Checklist for Liverpool Business

5. UK Business Bank Account Details

Account must be in the exact limited company name.

When you log in to Stripe (<https://dashboard.stripe.com>) to complete your merchant onboarding, enter these exact settings:

Stripe Setting Field	Recommended Setting for Green Clean Group
Country & Currency	United Kingdom (GB) British Pound (£ / GBP)
Industry / MCC Code	Cleaning, Janitorial, & Maintenance Services (MCC: 7349)
Statement Descriptor	GREENCLEAN LIV (Appears on customer bank statements - max 22 chars)
Support Phone Number	07359 068284 (UK mobile for customer booking dispatch)
Support Email	contact@greencleangroup.co.uk (Official contact mailbox)
Website URL	https://greencleangroup.co.uk (Includes Terms & Cancellation policies)
Payout Schedule	Automatic Rolling 2-day or weekly direct to your UK bank account

5. Handing Over Stripe API Keys to Activate the Website

Once your Stripe account is verified, you must copy 2 keys from your Stripe Dashboard and provide them to your web developer so customer card payments go directly to you:

Step-by-Step API Key Retrieval:

1. Log into <https://dashboard.stripe.com>
2. Switch toggle at the top left from 'Test mode' to 'Live mode'.
3. Navigate to: Developers > API Keys.
4. Copy your Publishable Key (starts with pk_live_...) -> Website Frontend.
5. Click 'Reveal live key' and copy Secret Key (starts with sk_live_...) -> Website Backend (.env).
6. Send these keys securely to your web developer to paste into the server configuration.

6. Stripe UK Transaction Pricing & Fee Structure

Stripe UK operates on a pay-as-you-go model with no monthly subscription, no terminal rental fee, and no setup charge. You are only charged when you successfully receive a customer booking:

Card Type / Payment Method	Stripe UK Fee per Transaction	Example: £65.00 Oven Clean
Standard UK Debit / Credit Cards (Visa, Mastercard)	1.4% + 20p	Fee: £1.18 You Receive: £63.82
UK Commercial / Business Cards & Amex	1.9% + 20p	Fee: £1.44 You Receive: £63.56
Pay Locally on Arrival (Cash to Technician)	0.0% (Zero Fee)	Fee: £0.00 You Receive: £65.00
Payouts to UK Bank Account via BACS / Faster Pay	Instant (0.00)	Transferred automatically every 2 days

7. Action Checklist for the Business Owner

Complete these 6 simple steps to start receiving card payments from Liverpool customers:

[] 1	Open / Prepare UK Bank Account – Ensure you have your 6-digit Sort Code and 8-digit Account Number ready.
[] 2	Have UK Tax & Identification Ready – Have your UTR (if Sole Trader) or CRN (if Ltd) plus photo ID and proof of address.
[] 3	Sign Up at Stripe.com – Go to https://dashboard.stripe.com/register and select United Kingdom.
[] 4	Fill In Business Details – Set Statement Descriptor to 'GREENCLEAN LIV' and support phone to 07359 068284.
[] 5	Activate Live Mode – Complete verification, switch to Live mode, and copy your live API Keys.
[] 6	Provide Keys to Developer – Send your Publishable & Secret Keys to your developer to activate live payments.

Technical Support & Assistance:

If you need assistance during your Stripe onboarding or have questions regarding UK banking verification, your web development team is available to assist you at every step.

Website: <https://greencleangroup.co.uk> | Serving Liverpool & Merseyside with 100% Eco-Friendly Care.

